weather, night sky, plane tracker
How to use it

This shows the weather for the town you choose, the planes overhead, earthquakes, and the night sky. Keep it plugged in, and give it your home Wi-Fi. Wi-Fi is 2.4 GHz. Power is USB-C.

When the power cable is plugged in, it can take a full minute before the numbers show. Each reading arrives on its own, so the picture fills in as those readings finish.

First time

1. Plug in the power cable. It comes on.

2. Tap WI-FI. It is under MORE on the left. It also shows on the first page when the network is not joined yet. Tap SCAN and pick your network, or type the name. Type the password on the keyboard. ABC switches to capital letters. !# switches to numbers and symbols. Tap SAVE.

If it joins, you go on to the place, or back to the main page if the town is already saved. If it says no join, check the name and the password and tap SAVE again.

3. Tap PLACE. Type a US city or ZIP and tap SEARCH. Tap the matching place. The clock and the weather follow that town. Give it a minute. The numbers fill in as they arrive.

The clock stays blank until that town's time zone comes in. It shows hours and minutes.

The buttons along the left

NOW is the weather. WEEK is the next 7 days. AIR is the planes overhead. SKY opens the night sky. MORE opens place, Wi-Fi, quakes, launches, setup, and about.

Now

The large number is the temperature. Under it is the sky right now, what it feels like, and the UV. After dark the UV is 0.

NEXT 24 HOURS is a line of the temperature. A short mark under a point means rain is more likely then. The pressure sits on that card. It can say rising, falling, or steady. The arc beside it is the sun. It moves from sunrise on the left to sunset on the right. The times under the arc are for your town.

WIND, HUMID, and RAIN are the three small cards. Humidity can also show the air number. Rain is the amount expected today. If TIDES is set to SHOW, the next high and low sit on the bottom line. Away from the coast, that line says no coast tide.

The row under that is the next few days. The high is the warm number. The low is the cool number.

The bottom line is for warnings. On a clear, quiet day it says ALL CLEAR. If the sky is cloudy or wet and nothing is posted, it says NO WARNINGS. If a warning is posted, that line names it. Warnings are for places in the United States. If a recent earthquake is within about 200 miles, that line can name it instead.

When ALERTS is ON, that warning or close earthquake stays until you tap CLEAR. CLEAR drops that one. A later, different one shows again. When ALERTS is OFF, the line follows the latest report and drops off by itself. Tap MORE, then QUAKES, for the list.

Week

Seven days. Each row is the day, the sky, the high, the low, the chance of rain, and how much rain.

Planes

The list is the closest planes in the range you picked. The choices are 20, 40, and 80 nautical miles. Height is in feet. Speed is in knots. A line on a dot is the direction that plane is heading. The rings are the range. N is north. Your town is the center.

The list refreshes while this page is open.

Night sky

SKY opens eight pages. Tap BACK on any of them to return to that menu.

STAR MAP is the sky above you. The center is overhead. The rim is the horizon. N is north. After dark the constellations are drawn and the brighter stars are named. In daylight the sun is on the circle and the stars stay off, because the real sky hides them.

TONIGHT lists what is above the horizon, highest first. The line is the height in degrees and the direction. The brighter stars wait until the sun is down.

PLANETS lists the moon and five planets. The line is the height in degrees and the direction, such as west. Below horizon means it is under the horizon.

MOON is the moon phase, and the percent is how much of it is lit.

ROCKS is asteroids and comets. A line that says up is a rough height.

SATELLITES is the space station, Tiangong, and Hubble. The space station line is live. The other two use a saved orbit, so they name the tilt and how long one trip around the earth takes.

ISS WORLD is a photo of the earth. The night side is darker. The gold dot is the sun. The cool line is one trip of the station. The coral square is the station, live. The cool dot is your town. Under the photo are the next times it is high enough to see, and only while the sun is down. Kp is the aurora number. 0 is quiet and 9 is severe. About 4 is unsettled, 5 is active, and 7 is a storm.

METEORS is the yearly showers and the month they peak.

Quakes

WORLD shows the larger earthquakes from around the world. USA shows earthquakes in the United States. Alaska and Hawaii sit in their own boxes. Your town is the cool dot. Tap a dot or a line for the magnitude, the place, how many miles away it is, the depth, and the time. Tap the earthquake line on the main page to open that same page.

Launches

A short list of upcoming rockets. The time is in UTC.

Place

Type a US city or a ZIP code. Tap SEARCH. Tap the match. The clock, the weather, the planes, and the sky follow that place.

Wi-Fi

SCAN looks for networks. Tap one to fill the name, then type the password. SAVE stores the name and password and tries to join. RESET forgets the network name and password.

Wi-Fi is 2.4 GHz.

Setup

LOOK is DARK or LIGHT. It starts dark.

LAMP is DIM, MID, or BRIGHT. Bright is full. Dim and mid are softer.

TEMP is F or C. The choice stays until you change it.

ALERTS is ON or OFF. ON keeps a warning, or an earthquake within about 200 miles, on the main page until you tap CLEAR.

TIDES is SHOW or HIDE. SHOW puts the next high and low on the main page when a coast station is close.

ABOUT is for updates.

FACTORY RESET clears the saved town, the network, and the choices. It restarts. It does not change anything else in your house.

The first time it starts, if a town and a network were already saved on it, it keeps them. After a factory reset it does not copy that saved town again. Type the Wi-Fi and the place once more.

Updates

Tap MORE, then ABOUT. That page shows the version.

Tap CHECK. Leave it on Wi-Fi. If nothing newer is waiting, it says newest firmware already installed.

If a newer one is ready, it shows that version and asks you to tap INSTALL. Leave it plugged in. Do not unplug it while it says it is downloading. It restarts on its own when it is done.

The first copy still goes on over USB. If INSTALL says it needs a second slot, the copy stays as it is, and the next copy goes on over USB.

A few things that are normal

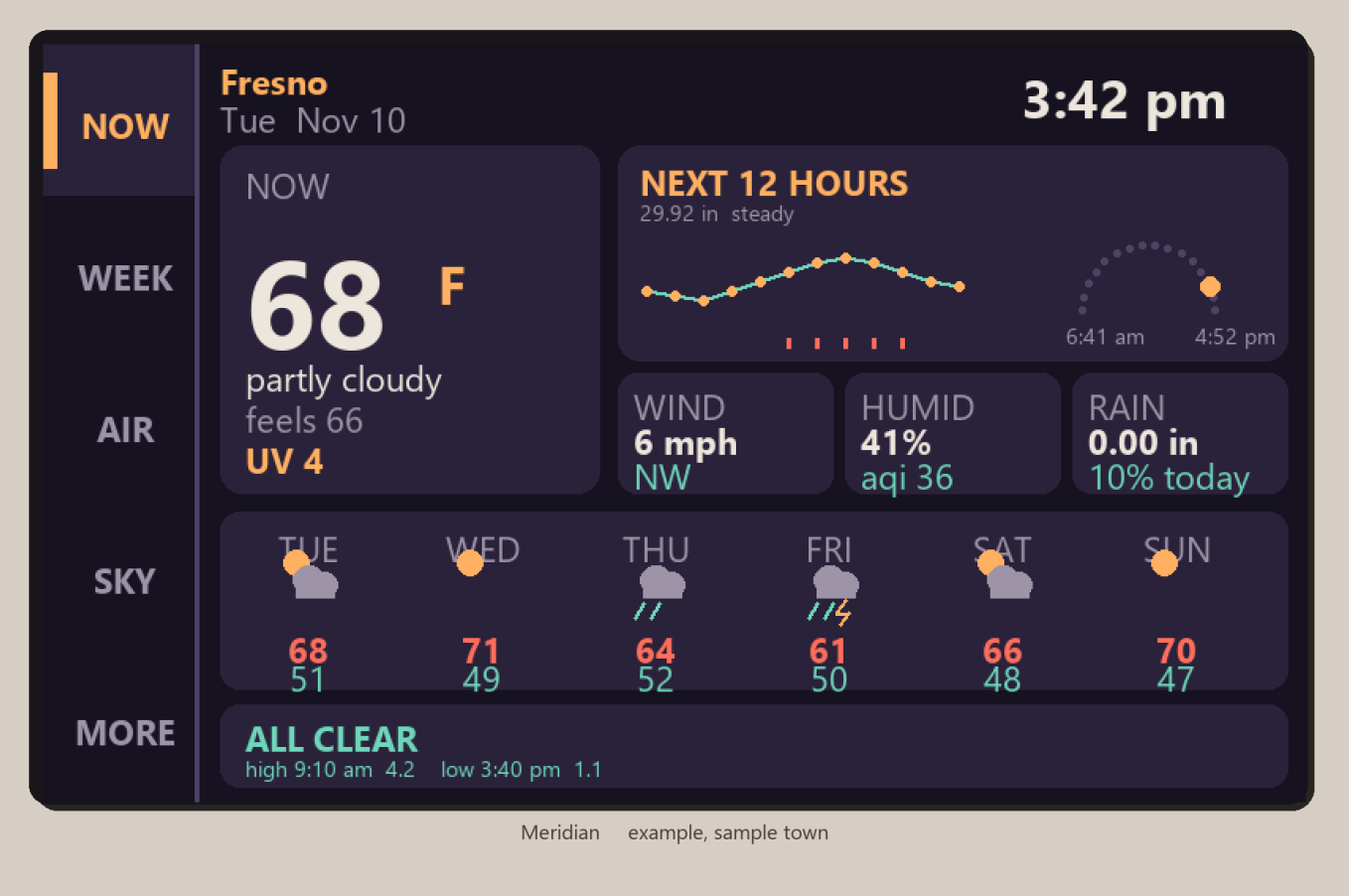
Pictures in the shop use a sample town. Yours shows the town you picked. The numbers in the pictures are samples.

If the Wi-Fi drops, the last numbers stay. Join the network again when you can.

Example pictures

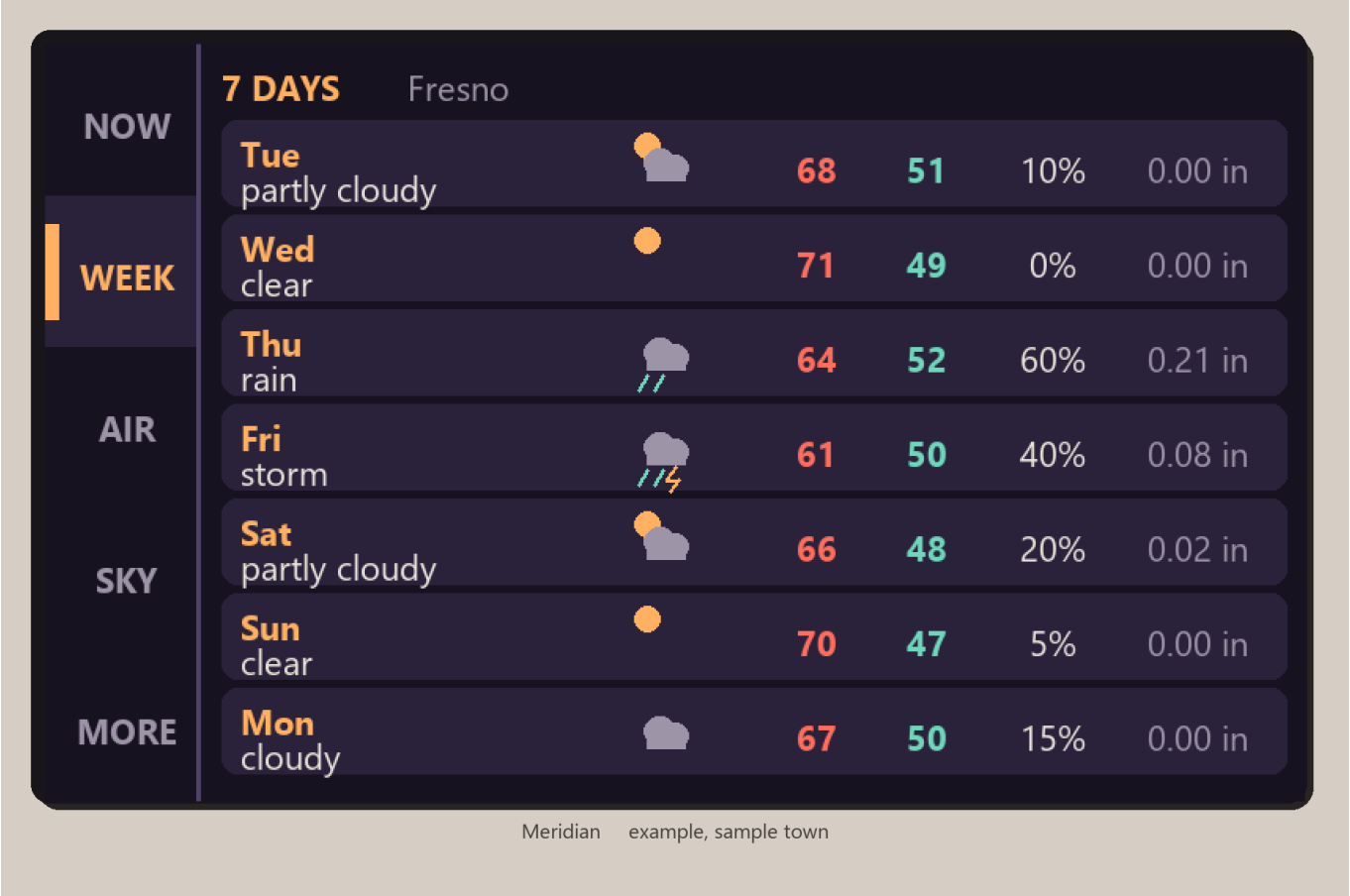
These pictures use a sample town. Yours shows the town you picked.

Now

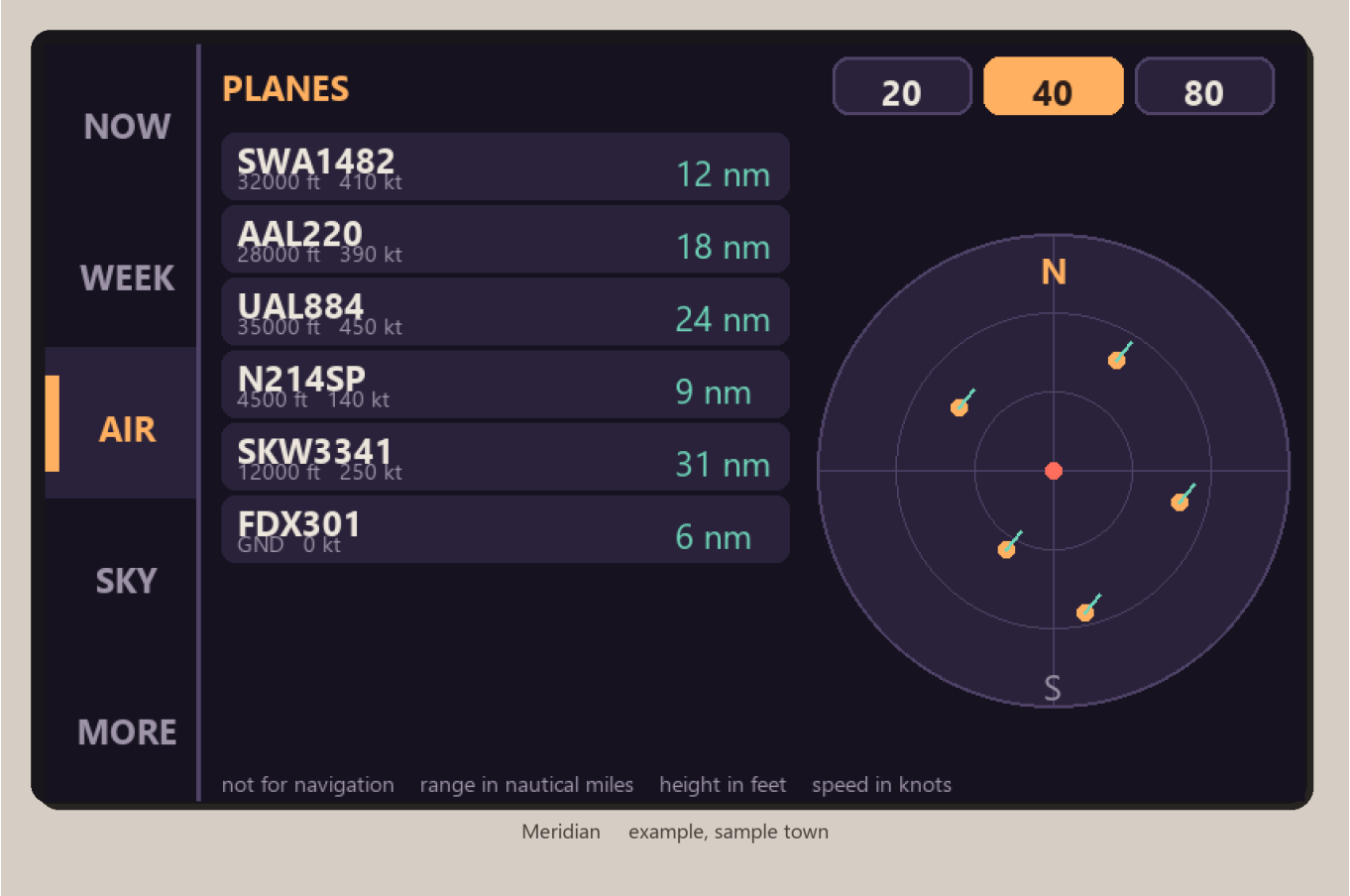


Meridian example, sample town

Week


NOW
WEEK
AIR
SKY
MORE
7 DAYS
Fresno
Tue
partly cloudy
68
51
10%
0.00 in
Wed
clear
71
49
0%
0.00 in
Thu
rain
64
52
60%
0.21 in
Fri
storm
61
50
40%
0.08 in
Sat
partly cloudy
66
48
20%
0.02 in
Sun
clear
70
47
5%
0.00 in
Mon
cloudy
67
50
15%
0.00 in
Meridian example, sample town

Planes


NOW
WEEK
AIR
SKY
MORE
PLANES
20
40
80
SWA1482
32000 ft 410 kt
12 nm
AAL220
28000 ft 390 kt
18 nm
UAL884
35000 ft 450 kt
24 nm
N214SP
4500 ft 140 kt
9 nm
SKW3341
12000 ft 250 kt
31 nm
FDX301
GND 0 kt
6 nm
N
S
not for navigation
range in nautical miles
height in feet
speed in knots
Meridian
example, sample town

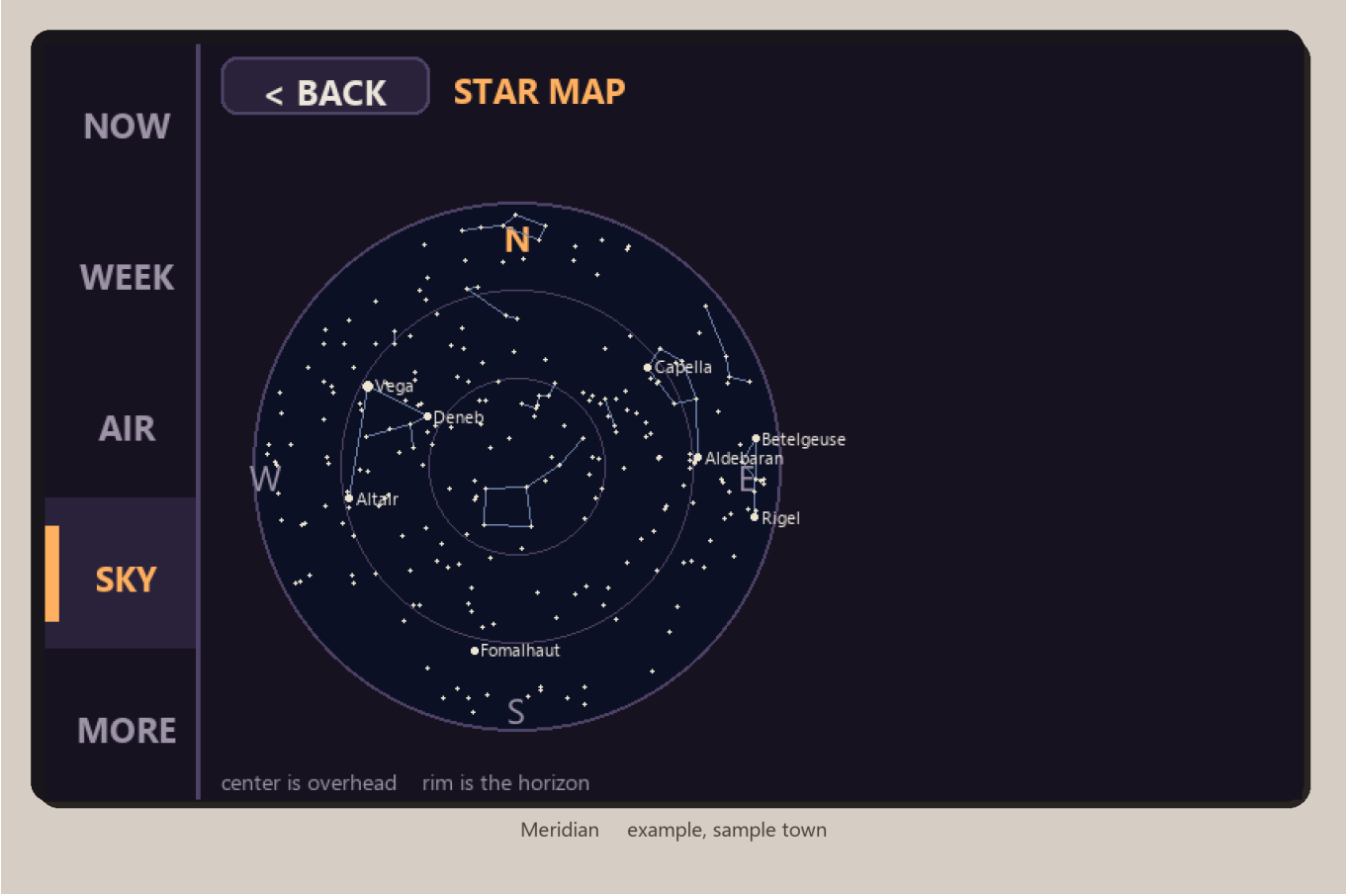
Night sky



Space station


< BACK
ISS WORLD
VISIBLE
ASIA
SOUTH AMERICA
AUSTRALIA
27.3 -117.0 420 km 188 degrees south up 24
VISIBLE PASSES
Tue 6:12 pm from W 6 min
Wed 5:41 am from E 4 min
Wed 7:18 pm from SW 5 min
Thu 6:48 pm from W 7 min
Kp 3.3 unsettled
coral square is the station gold dot is the sun cool line is the path
a pass is when it is up and the sun is down
Meridian example, sample town

Star map


NOW
WEEK
AIR
SKY
MORE
< BACK
STAR MAP
N
W
E
S
Capella
Vega
Deneb
Betelgeuse
Aldebaran
Altair
Rigel
Fomalhaut
center is overhead
rim is the horizon
Meridian
example, sample town

Moon

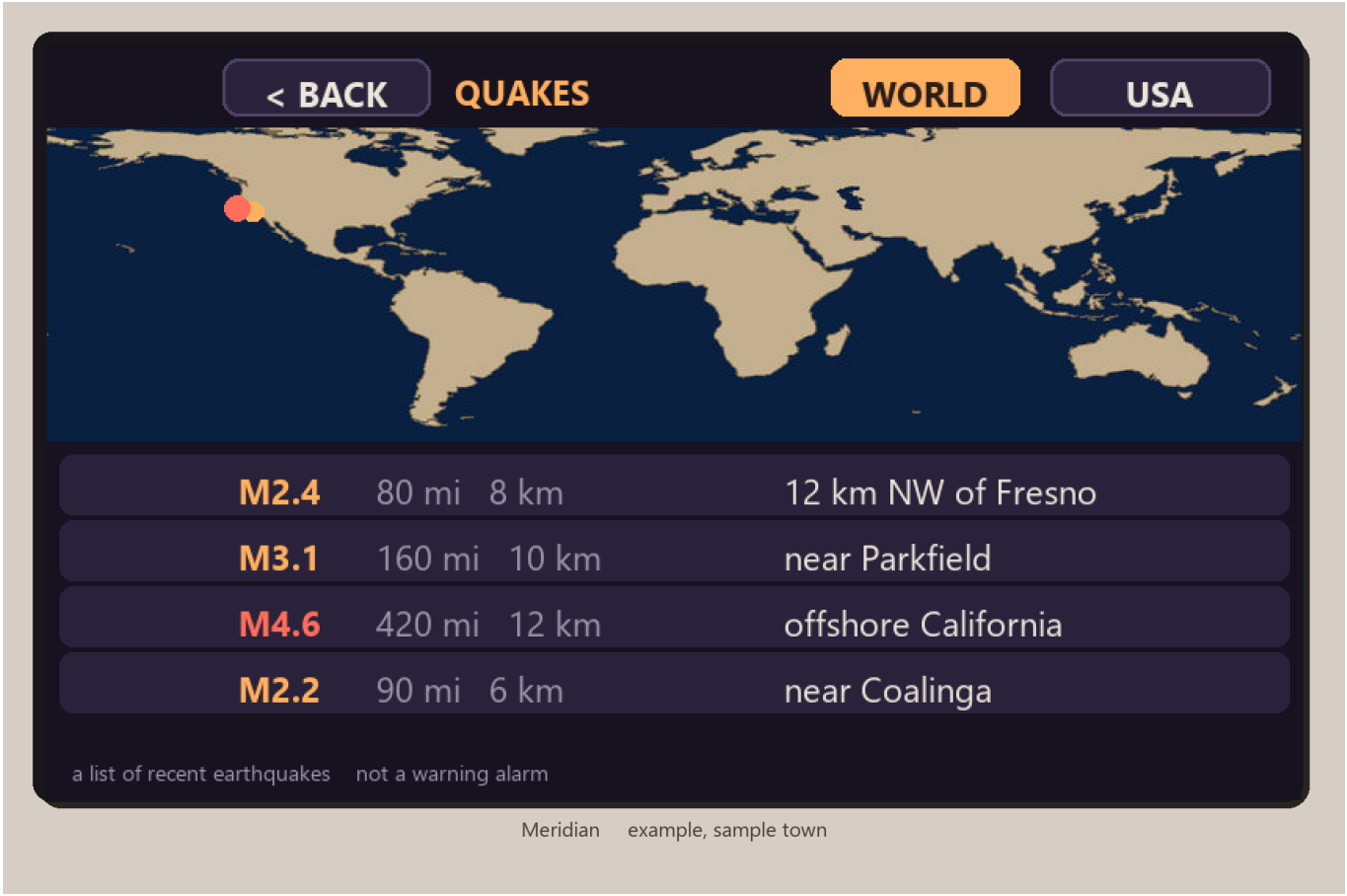

NOW
WEEK
AIR
SKY
MORE
< BACK
MOON
moon phase
85% lit
up 36 118 degrees southeast
the bright part is the lit side
Meridian example, sample town

Planets

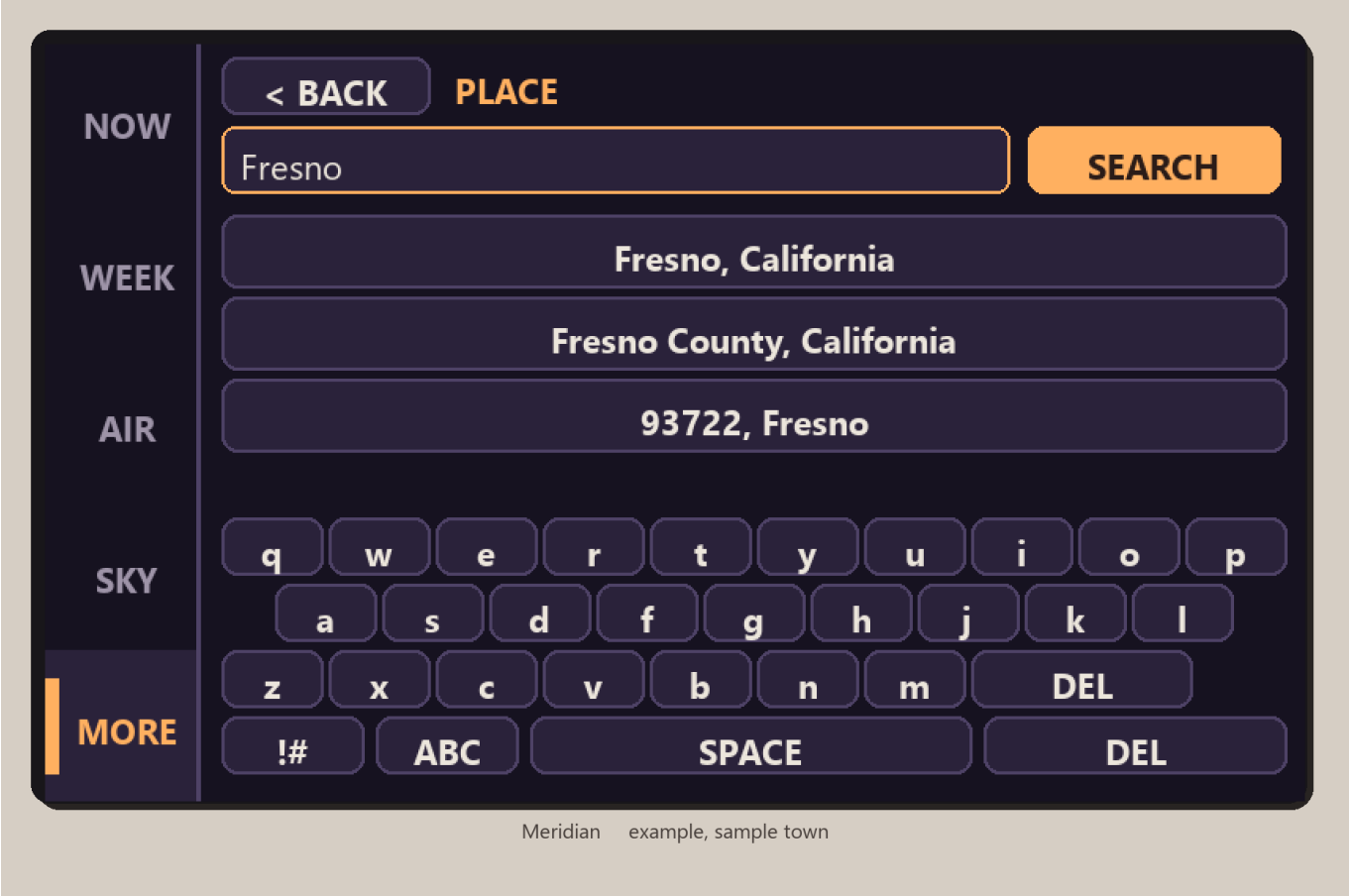


Meridian example, sample town

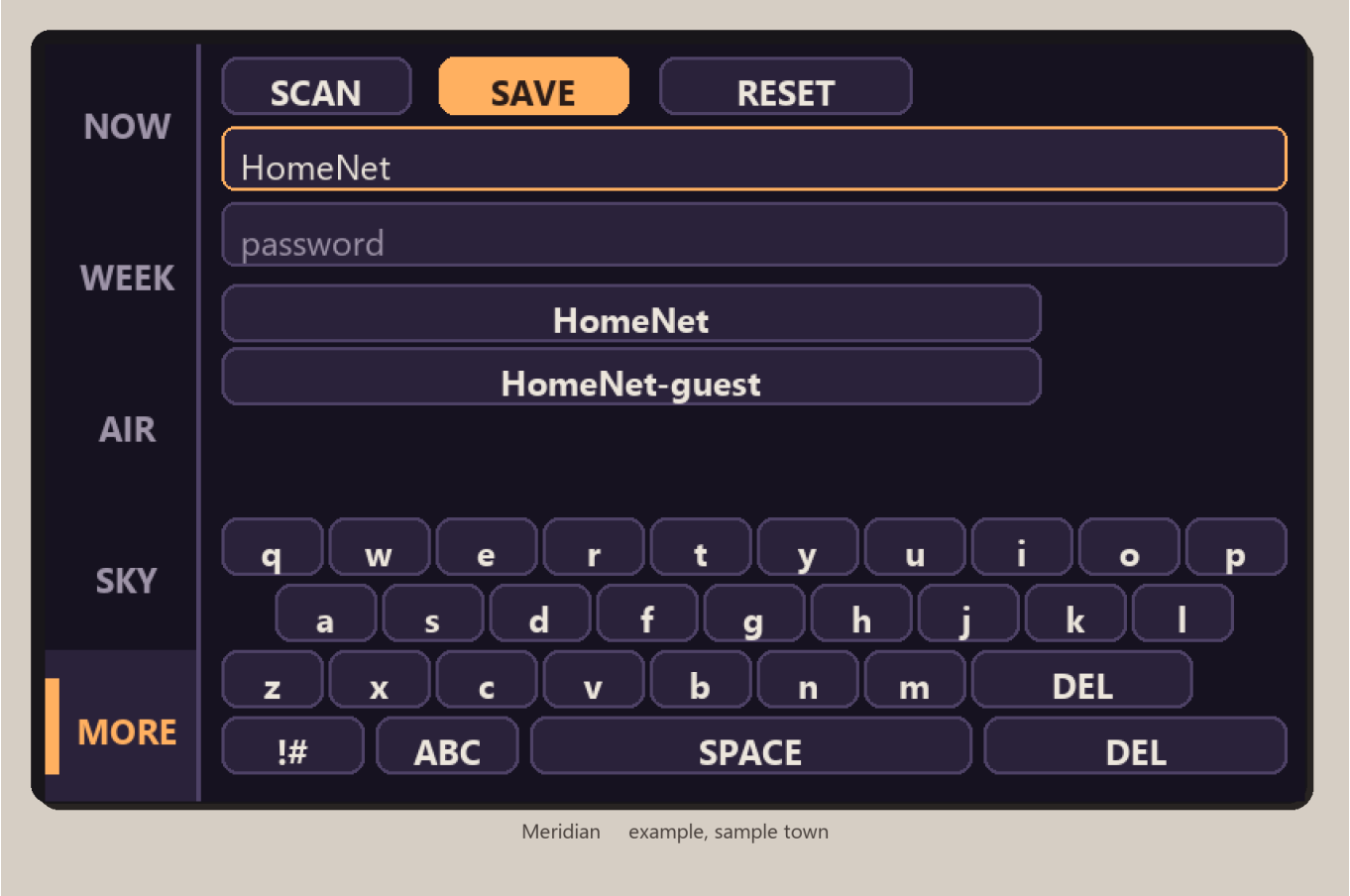
Quakes


< BACK
QUAKES
WORLD
USA
M2.4 80 mi 8 km 12 km NW of Fresno
M3.1 160 mi 10 km near Parkfield
M4.6 420 mi 12 km offshore California
M2.2 90 mi 6 km near Coalinga
a list of recent earthquakes not a warning alarm
Meridian example, sample town

Place


NOW
WEEK
AIR
SKY
MORE
< BACK
PLACE
Fresno
SEARCH
Fresno, California
Fresno County, California
93722, Fresno
q w e r t y u i o p
a s d f g h j k l
z x c v b n m DEL
!# ABC SPACE DEL
Meridian example, sample town

Wi-Fi



Meridian example, sample town

Setup



Meridian example, sample town